



ELCOM Administrator Guide

A complete, step-by-step reference for Electoral Commission administrators running student elections on StudElect. From first login to final results publication.

ELCOM ADMINISTRATORS

ALL ELECTION TYPES

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STUDELECT.NG

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Overview — What is StudElect?

StudElect is a **multi-tenant digital election platform** built specifically for Nigerian tertiary institutions. It allows student organisations — SUG, NESA, NACOS, faculty associations, departmental associations, and more — to conduct fully cryptographic, constitutionally compliant elections entirely online.

As an ELCOM (Electoral Commission) administrator, you are the operator of your organisation's election. StudElect gives you the tools to manage the entire process — from building the voter roll to publishing verified results — without needing any technical background.

— Key Concepts

TERM	WHAT IT MEANS
Institution	Your university or polytechnic (e.g. University of Ibadan, UNILAG)
Organisation	Your student body within that institution (e.g. NESA, NACOS, SUG)
Voter Roll	The official list of students eligible to vote in your election
Accreditation	The process by which a voter confirms their identity and receives a one-time voting token
PIN	A 6-digit one-time code generated per student for accreditation. Students enter this in the voter booth.
Ballot Token	A cryptographic key issued after accreditation that authorises exactly one vote. Cannot be reused.
Election Status	PENDINGLIVEPAUSEDENDED



SECURITY ARCHITECTURE

No two votes can be linked back to a specific student. Ballot selections are cryptographically decoupled from voter identity. Even the ELCOM administrator cannot see who voted for whom — only the aggregate count per candidate.

Before You Begin — What You Need

Before running an election on StudElect, make sure the following are ready:

- ☐ Your login credentials from the StudElect platform administrator (email and password)
- ☐ A laptop or desktop computer with a modern browser (Chrome, Firefox, Edge, or Safari)
- ☐ A stable internet connection
- ☐ Your voter roll in Excel format (.xlsx) — matric numbers, full names, departments, and academic levels
- ☐ Your list of positions (offices) to be contested
- ☐ Your list of cleared/screened candidates per position
- ☐ The agreed election date(s) and time window
- ☐ Confirmation from the platform administrator that your organisation's license is **ACTIVE**



IMPORTANT

The election cannot go LIVE if your organisation's payment license is not active. Contact your StudElect platform representative if your election is being blocked by a payment hold.

Logging In for the First Time

Your login link is specific to your institution. It follows this format:

```
https://studelect.ng/{your-institution-slug}/admin
```

For example, if your institution is University of Ibadan and your organisation is NESAs, your admin panel is at:

```
https://studelect.ng/ui/admin
```

Alternatively, you can go to the general login page at <https://studelect.ng/admin/login> and enter your credentials there.

1**Open your institution's admin URL**

Navigate to studelect.ng/{institution}/admin in your browser. You will be redirected to the login page if you are not already signed in.

2**Enter your email and password**

Use the credentials provided to you by the StudElect platform administrator. Your password is case-sensitive.

3**Click "Sign In to Admin Panel"**

You will be authenticated and redirected to your ELCOM dashboard for your specific organisation.

4**Verify you are in the correct organisation**

Check the top of the dashboard — it should show your institution name, organisation name, and your role as "ELCOM Commissioner". If it is wrong, sign out and contact the platform administrator.

**SECURITY — DO NOT SHARE**

Never share your admin password with anyone, including other ELCOM members. If you believe your credentials are compromised, contact the platform administrator immediately to reset them.

Navigating the ELCOM Dashboard & Organization Branding

The ELCOM dashboard is your mission control room. It provides real-time telemetry, candidate curation, voter roll verification, and emergency safeguards in one unified interface:

DASHBOARD SECTION	WHAT YOU DO HERE
Overview / Telemetry	Real-time live telemetry — registered voter counts, accreditation rates, ballots submitted, and percentage turnout.
Election Settings	Configure election rules: voting hours, auto-pause closing timers, dues gating, registration lock, and support contact details.
Voter Roll	Manage registered students, filter by department/level, toggle dues clearance, reset voter PINs, or promote administrators.
Candidates & Offices	Add elective offices, nominate candidates, upload high-resolution profile photos, enter campaign manifestos, and screen clearance.
Election Control	Lifecycle management: transition seamlessly between PENDING → LIVE → PAUSED → ENDED.
Results & Tally	Monitor certified vote totals per post with bar charts, and control public visibility (Sealed vs. Live).
Audit Log	Cryptographic Merkle receipt ledger — immutable ballot hash records, anonymised voter tokens, and verification timestamps.
Disaster Recovery	1-Click export and restore tools for complete election data safety.

— Organization Branding & Logo Upload (DP)

In the top navigation header of your ELCOM dashboard, locate the camera icon beside your organisation badge. Clicking this allows you to upload your official departmental, faculty, or union logo (PNG or JPEG, up to 2.5MB).

- **Strict Isolation:** Your logo is strictly scoped to your organisation and stored securely. It will never overwrite or leak into other campus organizations.
- **Automatic Booth Branding:** Once uploaded, your logo automatically brands both your administrator control room and the student-facing voting booth at `studelect.ng/{institution}/{org}`.

— ELCOM Public Support Desk

Under the **Election Settings** tab, you can configure your committee's official support channels: ELCOM Chairman's Name, Official WhatsApp Help Desk number, and Support Email.

These details are rendered live at the base of the student voting portal so that accredited students who have questions, need clarification on their departmental dues, or require accreditation assistance can contact your committee directly in real time.

— 1-Click Disaster Recovery (Backup & Restore)

Under the Settings tab, StudElect provides a built-in **Disaster Recovery Suite**:

- **Export Election Backup (JSON):** Downloads a comprehensive, timestamped snapshot of your entire election state — including your rules, elective offices, nominated candidates with profile photos, cast encrypted ballots, voter deduplication ledger, and commissioner credentials. Keep this file downloaded to an external drive or secure cloud storage.
- **Restore Election Backup:** In the unlikely event of an accidental modification or device emergency, you can restore your election snapshot with a single click. The restore process strictly merges and replaces data for your organisation only, preserving other campus elections untouched.

Setting Up Election Rules & Registration Locks

Before accrediting voters or launching polls, configure your operational parameters in the **Election Settings** tab. These rules govern access security, timeline enforcement, and transparency.

1	Set Official Election Title & Description Provide your constitutional election title (e.g., " <i>NESA General Elections 2025/2026 Academic Session</i> ") and any preamble instructions for voters.
2	Configure Voting Hours & Auto-Pause Closing Timer Specify official poll opening and closing timestamps. Outside these hours, the voter booth automatically displays a polite countdown or "Voting Closed" screen even if the admin state is LIVE.
3	Enforce Constitutional Eligibility Criteria Configure accreditation prerequisites: Departmental Dues Payment (blocks students with unpaid dues) and Disciplinary Standing (Good Standing vs. Suspended).
4	Manage Student Registration Lock ("Open" vs "Closed") Control whether new students can self-register on the voter booth. When set to Open , students can register and obtain PINs. When set to Closed , new sign-ups are barred.
5	Configure Results Visibility (Sealed vs. Live) Choose when candidate tallies become public: Hidden / Sealed (recommended during voting to prevent bandwagon effects), Live Stream (tallies visible in real time), or Post-Election (automatically unsealed upon reaching ENDED status).
6	Save Election Rules Click "Save Election Rules". All changes take effect immediately across all active voter sessions.



CRUCIAL RULE: CLOSING REGISTRATION NEVER BLOCKS EXISTING VOTERS

When you toggle **Student Registration to Closed**, you are strictly preventing *new unverified accounts* from signing up.

Existing registered students are NOT locked out! Any student who has already registered or was

imported on the voter roll can log in with their Matriculation Number and PIN and cast their ballot without any interruption. Closing registration is standard best practice right before opening the polls.



BEST PRACTICE: SEAL RESULTS DURING VOTING

Keep results **Hidden / Sealed** until the official close of voting. Broadcasting candidate margins while voting is open can trigger bandwagon voting, candidate voter suppression, or public anxiety. Unseal results only after voting is formally declared ENDED.

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Building Your Voter Roll & Online Student Self-Registration

The voter roll is the authoritative register of students eligible to participate in your election. StudElect provides two flexible methods to assemble your voter roll: bulk Excel roster upload and direct student online self-registration.

— Method A — Bulk Excel Roster Upload (.xlsx)

If your department or faculty executive already possesses an official roster of registered students, you can import all eligible voters in seconds using an Excel spreadsheet.

COLUMN	FIELD NAME	REQUIRED?	EXAMPLE
A	Matriculation Number	Yes	200404/BE/EEE/001 or 214950
B	Full Name	Yes	Adebayo Chinonso Felix
C	Department	Yes	Economics
D	Academic Level	Yes	300
E	Email Address (NDPR)	Yes	adebayo@student.ui.edu.ng
F	Phone / WhatsApp	Optional	08012345678
G	Dues Paid (Yes/No)	Optional	Yes

Prepare your Excel spreadsheet

1	Row 1 must contain headers. Student records begin on row 2. Remove any merged cells or formatting formulas.
2	Click "Voter Roll" → "Upload Roster" Select your <code>.xlsx</code> file. StudElect previews the first rows and validates matric number uniqueness.
3	Confirm Import & Auto-Generate PINs Click "Import". The platform creates each student account and automatically generates a unique organization-prefixed PIN (e.g. <code>NES-4892</code>) for every voter.

— Method B — Online Student Self-Registration ("New Voter? Get PIN")

In many university elections, an up-to-date departmental Excel sheet is unavailable. StudElect provides an automated, zero-stress self-registration portal built directly into your voter booth.

1	Direct Students to Your Voter Booth URL Share your organization's booth link: <code>https://studelect.ng/{institution}/{organization}</code> (e.g. <code>https://studelect.ng/ui/nesa</code> or <code>https://studelect.ng/ui/renarsa</code>).
2	Student Clicks "New Voter? Get PIN" On the voter booth home page, students who do not yet have credentials click the "New Voter? Get PIN" tab to launch the registration modal.
3	Student Completes Registration Details The student inputs their Matriculation Number , Full Legal Name , Academic Level (100–500), Department , compulsory Email Address , and optional Phone/WhatsApp Number .
4	Instant Organization-Prefixed PIN Issuance Upon submission, StudElect instantly generates an 8-character PIN prefixed by the organization abbreviation (e.g. <code>NES-4892</code> for NESA or <code>REN-7104</code> for RENARSA). The modal provides a 1-click "Copy PIN" button with a confirmation notice.



WHY EMAIL IS COMPULSORY (NDPR COMPLIANCE)

Under the Nigeria Data Protection Regulation (NDPR) and electoral integrity standards, every self-registered voter must provide a valid email address. This email address serves as the verified audit

— Self-Service PIN Recovery ("Lookup My PIN")

During elections, students frequently forget or misplace their PINs. StudElect eliminates admin bottlenecks with the **"Lookup My PIN"** self-service tool:

- On the voter booth accreditation screen, any registered student can click **"Lookup My PIN"**.
- They enter their registered Matriculation Number.
- The system verifies their enrollment and instantly displays their existing PIN on screen with a "Copy PIN" shortcut.
- ELCOM administrators do not need to manually field hundreds of "I lost my PIN" WhatsApp messages on election day!

— Locking Student Self-Registration Before Polls Open

Once your registration window has elapsed (e.g., midnight before election day):

- Navigate to **Election Settings** on your ELCOM dashboard.
- Toggle **"Student Registration"** from **Open** to **Closed**.
- Click **"Save Election Rules"**.

Once closed, new visitors to the voting booth will see a clear notice that registration has ended. **Crucially: All existing registered voters can continue to log in and vote uninterrupted throughout the voting window!**

Managing Student Eligibility & PIN Recovery

The **Voter Roll** tab provides complete oversight over every registered student, enabling ELCOM to enforce dues requirements, manage disciplinary standing, and handle individual student support.

— Departmental Dues Payment Clearance

If your association constitution requires departmental dues payment as a voting prerequisite:

1

Search for the Student

Use the real-time search bar in the Voter Roll tab to find the student by Matriculation Number or Name.

2

Toggle Dues Status

Click the dues badge (Paid / Unpaid). The status updates immediately in the database.

3

Student Accredits Instantly

The student can immediately refresh their voter booth browser and proceed past the accreditation gate.

— Disciplinary Standing (Active vs. Suspended)

If a student is on academic suspension, disciplinary probation, or otherwise disqualified from voting, click **"Deactivate"** next to their name. A deactivated student is barred from accreditation even with a valid PIN.

— Manual PIN Reset (Admin Override)

While students should first be directed to the **"Lookup My PIN"** button on the voter booth, ELCOM administrators can also generate a brand-new PIN at any time by clicking **"Reset PIN"** in the Voter Roll row. A fresh org-prefixed PIN is generated and displayed for you to share directly with the student.



PIN CONFIDENTIALITY RULE

Voter PINs are single-use cryptographic credentials. Never paste a list of PINs into public WhatsApp groups or faculty bulletin boards. Only share PINs directly with the verified owner via private communication.

— Promoting a Student to ELCOM Commissioner

If you need to assign assistant returning officers, polling agents, or fellow committee members to the admin dashboard, find their record on the voter roll and click **"Promote to Admin"**. Their account will immediately gain administrative access to your organisation's control panel.

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Adding Positions & Nominating Candidates (Photos & Manifestos)

StudElect structures your ballot into a clean, two-tier hierarchy: **Elective Offices (Positions)** and **Nominated Candidates**. Before launching your election, set up your constitutional offices and nominate screened contestants.

— Tier 1 — Create Elective Offices

1	Navigate to the "Candidates" Tab Open the Candidates tab on your ELCOM dashboard. Click the blue "Add New Elective Office" button.
2	Enter Office Title Provide the constitutional title, e.g. <i>"Executive President"</i>, <i>"Vice President"</i>, <i>"General Secretary"</i>, <i>"Financial Secretary"</i>, <i>"Public Relations Officer (PRO)"</i>.
3	Enter Office Description & Responsibilities Briefly describe the responsibilities of the post. This helps educate voters on the duties of each executive office.
4	Save Elective Office Click "Save Office". The post is created as a dedicated office card ready for candidate nominations.

— Tier 2 — Nominate Candidates (Photos, Monikers & Manifestos)

Once an office card exists, nominate one or more screened candidates for that post:

	Click "Nominate Candidate" on the Office Card
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1	Locate the target office card and click the "Nominate Candidate" button to open the nomination modal.
2	Enter Candidate Identity Details Fill in the candidate's Full Legal Name (e.g. <i>Olawale Adebayo Sunday</i>) and their student Matriculation Number .
3	Add Campaign Moniker / Nickname Enter the candidate's popular campaign moniker (e.g. <i>"Hon. Catalyst"</i> , <i>"The Econometrician"</i>). This appears prominently on the digital ballot card alongside their official name so voters immediately recognise their candidate.
4	Upload Candidate Passport / Profile Photo Use the file selector to upload a clear passport or campaign photograph (JPEG, PNG, or WebP up to 2.5MB). An instant thumbnail preview confirms that the candidate's face is centered and sharp.
5	Enter Campaign Manifesto / Bio Statement Paste the candidate's summary manifesto or core policy pillars. Voters in the booth can expand and read this statement before casting their vote.
6	Set Screening Status to "Cleared" Select the ELCOM screening outcome: • Cleared (green badge): Candidate has passed all constitutional checks and will appear on the student ballot. • Nominated / Pending (yellow badge): Candidate is awaiting screening; hidden from the student ballot. • Disqualified (red badge): Candidate failed screening; permanently hidden from the student ballot.

— Editing or Removing Candidates

On any candidate card:

- Click the **Pencil (Edit) icon** to revise spelling, update the campaign manifesto, or upload a new profile picture.
- Click the **Trash (Delete) icon** to remove a withdrawn nominee.

✓ **PRE-FLIGHT AUDIT**

Before launching your election LIVE, review each office card. Verify that every cleared candidate displays their high-resolution photo, correct moniker, and full name. Once votes start coming in, candidate lists cannot be modified to ensure cryptographic audit integrity.

Going LIVE — Launching the Election

This is the most important step. Once you set the election to **LIVE**, the voter booth opens and students can begin accrediting and casting ballots.

— Pre-Launch Checklist

- ☐ Election rules are saved (title, voting hours, eligibility, results visibility)
- ☐ Voter roll has been uploaded and verified
- ☐ All eligible students are marked as dues-paid (if required)
- ☐ All positions have been created
- ☐ All candidates have been added and marked as "Cleared"
- ☐ Platform license is **ACTIVE** (confirm with your StudElect representative)
- ☐ You have tested the voter booth URL and it loads correctly

— Setting the Election to LIVE

1**Go to "Election Control" on your dashboard**

Find the status control panel. The current status is PENDING.

2**Click "Set to LIVE"**

A confirmation dialog will appear. Read it carefully.

3**Confirm the action**

Click "Yes, Launch Election". The status changes to LIVE immediately.

4**Share the voter booth URL with students**

The voter booth is at `studelect.ng/{institution}/{org}`. Post this on your official WhatsApp group, notice board, or student portal announcement.



WHAT TO SHARE WITH STUDENTS

Send students this message:

"Dear [Org] members, voting is now open. Visit studelect.ng/{institution}/{org} to cast your ballot. You will need your matriculation number and the 6-digit PIN sent to you. Voting closes at [time]. Your vote is secret and cryptographically secured."

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During the Election — Real-Time Monitoring & Free-Tier Eco-Protection

While the election is LIVE, your dashboard provides real-time telemetry updated smoothly without reloading the page.

METRIC	WHAT IT TELLS YOU	ACTION IF CONCERN
Total Registered	Number of students currently on your voter roll	Should match your department or faculty enrollment expectation
Accredited	Students who have passed credential checks and entered the ballot booth	If low relative to total, broadcast reminders on official group chats
Ballots Cast	Number of successfully encrypted and verified ballots submitted	Tracks voter participation velocity in real time
Voter Turnout %	Ballots cast as an exact percentage of registered voters	Helps ELCOM monitor whether constitutional quorum has been achieved
Live Leaderboard	Real-time candidate vote tallies (if results visibility is set to Live)	We recommend keeping results Sealed until voting formally ends

— Zero-Hiccup Free-Tier Eco-Protection Architecture

During peak election hours, hundreds of students may be concurrently registering, reading manifestos, and casting ballots. StudElect incorporates high-efficiency architectural safeguards specifically engineered to guarantee uninterrupted, hiccup-free voting on database free-tiers (such as Supabase):

- **Zero-DB File Store for Ballot Counts:** Live ballot counts are decoupled from high-frequency SQL queries. When ballots are cast, counts are written to an atomic, append-only cryptographic ledger. The real-time telemetry polling reads this ledger without burdening the PostgreSQL database connection pool.

- **2.5-Second Telemetry Throttle:** Admin telemetry endpoints implement an in-memory caching layer with a 2.5-second TTL. Even if multiple ELCOM commissioners keep their dashboards open simultaneously, the server executes at most one refresh cycle per interval.
- **Smart Background Tab Hibernation:** If an administrator minimizes their browser window or switches to another tab, polling intervals are automatically halted to conserve bandwidth and execution units. Telemetry catches up instantly the moment the tab is brought back into active view.
- **Ballot Sealing (Bandwagon Mitigation):** When results are marked as Sealed in settings, candidate totals are completely withheld from public network payloads, preserving electoral secrecy and reducing bandwidth overhead.

— Pausing the Election

If an urgent dispute arises or there is a formal ELCOM resolution to pause voting (e.g., verifying a candidate credential), click **"Pause Election"** in the Election Control panel.



WHEN THE ELECTION IS PAUSED

The voter booth immediately displays a "Voting Temporarily Suspended" banner. Students cannot accredit or submit new ballots. All existing cast ballots remain intact. You can resume (set back to LIVE) at any moment with a single click.

— Handling Student Issues During Voting

STUDENT PROBLEM	YOUR ACTION
Cannot find matriculation number	Check the Voter Roll — they may not have completed self-registration. If registration is still open, send them to the booth to click "New Voter? Get PIN". If closed, you can add them manually.
Lost or forgot their voter PIN	Instruct the student to click "Lookup My PIN" on the booth accreditation screen and enter their matric number. Alternatively, click "Reset PIN" on their row in your Voter Roll tab.
Sees "Registration Closed" notice	Clarify that new registrations are closed. If they already registered previously, they only need to enter their Matriculation Number and PIN to accredit and vote — existing voters are never blocked!
"Dues not paid" error at accreditation	Verify their departmental receipt. If paid, find their record in Voter Roll and toggle dues to Paid. The student can immediately proceed.
"Already voted" error	StudElect strictly enforces one-vote-per-matric. Check the audit log to verify the timestamp of their cast ballot receipt. Ballots cannot be duplicated or cast twice.
Student selected wrong candidate accidentally	Once a cryptographic ballot is committed to the blockchain-style ledger, it is permanent and irreversible. Advise students to review their selections on the confirmation screen before final submission.

Closing the Election

When voting time is over, you must officially close (end) the election. This is a permanent action — once ended, the election cannot be set back to LIVE.

1**Confirm voting has ended**

Make a formal announcement in your student group that voting is closed. Give a 5-minute grace period for students who are mid-session.

2**Go to Election Control**

Click "End Election". A confirmation dialog will appear warning you that this action is irreversible.

3**Confirm**

The election status changes to **ENDED**. The voter booth immediately shows "Voting has closed." No further votes can be cast.

4**Note the final vote counts**

Take screenshots or download the results immediately. Go to the Results section and record the final tally for each position.

**GOOD PRACTICE**

Document the exact time the election ended, the final turnout percentage, and take a screenshot of the Results page. This forms part of your official electoral record and may be required for disputes.

Publishing Results

After closing the election, you can publish the results publicly on the platform. Published results are visible to all students at the voter booth URL — no login required.

1**Go to "Results" on your dashboard**

You will see the final vote tally per candidate per position, sorted from highest to lowest votes.

2

Review the results carefully

Verify total votes per position equals the number of ballots cast. If there is a discrepancy, check the audit log before publishing.

3

Toggle "Results Visibility" to Public

Click "Make Results Public". A green confirmation will appear. Results are now visible at

`studelect.ng/{institution}/{org}`.

4

Announce the results

Share the results link in your official student channels. Students can verify their ballot on the Verify page using their ballot receipt hash.

— Result Verification

Every student who voted received a **ballot receipt** containing a unique cryptographic hash. Students can go to `studelect.ng/{institution}/elections/{electionId}/verify` and enter their hash to confirm their vote was counted — without revealing who they voted for. This is part of StudElect's end-to-end verifiability guarantee.

Post-Election — Audit & Record Keeping

After the election ends, StudElect maintains a full cryptographic audit trail. This is important for transparency and for handling any petitions or disputes.

— Audit Log

The Audit Log shows every ballot event in the order it occurred. Each entry contains:

AUDIT FIELD	DESCRIPTION
Timestamp	The exact date and time the ballot was cast (to the millisecond)
Ballot Hash	A unique cryptographic fingerprint of this specific ballot
Previous Hash	The hash of the ballot before this one — forming an unbreakable chain
Voter Token	An anonymised token (not the student's matric number) proving this was a valid accredited voter
Chain Integrity	A verified/failed indicator showing whether the ballot chain is intact

— Downloading Records

Use the Export buttons on the Results and Voter Roll pages to download CSV files of final results and voter participation records. Store these securely as your official electoral archive for the session.



RECORD RETENTION

Keep your downloaded results and audit exports for a minimum of one full academic session. These may be required by your institution's Student Affairs office or in the event of an electoral petition.

Troubleshooting Common Issues

ISSUE	LIKELY CAUSE	SOLUTION
Cannot log in	Wrong password or email	Try the exact credentials provided. Contact your platform administrator for a reset.
Dashboard shows no data	No students uploaded yet	Upload your voter roll Excel file under Voter Roll → Upload Roster.
Election won't go LIVE	License is not ACTIVE	Contact your StudElect platform representative. A payment hold may be blocking activation.
Student gets "Not found" at voter booth	Student not on voter roll	Check their matric number carefully. Add them manually if they are eligible.
Candidate not appearing on ballot	Candidate screening status is not "Cleared"	Go to Candidates, find the candidate, change status to Cleared.
Student lost or forgot their PIN	PIN lost or misplaced	Instruct student to click "Lookup My PIN" on the booth accreditation screen. Alternatively, find them in Voter Roll and click "Reset PIN".
Student sees "Registration Closed"	ELCOM closed the self-registration window	If the student is already registered, have them log in using their Matric Number and PIN (existing voters are never locked out). If omitted in error, ELCOM can manually add them.
Candidate photo fails to upload	File format or size exceeds limit	Ensure image is in JPEG, PNG, or WebP format and under 2.5MB. Crop or compress image before uploading.
Results page shows 0 votes	Results are hidden / sealed	Go to Election Settings and toggle Results Visibility to Public or wait until election reaches ENDED.
Student voted twice error	They already cast a ballot	The system enforces one-vote-per-matric. Check the audit log for confirmation. This cannot be reversed.
Excel upload fails	File format or structure issue	Ensure it is a .xlsx file (not .xls or .csv). Check that row 1 is headers and data starts at row 2. Remove merged cells.
Voter booth is very slow	High simultaneous traffic	The platform auto-scales and caches telemetry. Advise students to refresh or try again in a moment. Stagger announcements so not all students rush to vote at the exact same minute.

If you encounter an issue not covered here, contact your StudElect platform representative via WhatsApp.

Always provide:

- Your institution and organisation name
- The exact error message or screenshot
- The approximate time the issue occurred
- The matric number of the affected student (if applicable)

Quick Reference Card



PRINT THIS PAGE

Cut out or keep this reference card handy on election day. It summarises the key URLs and workflow in one place.

— Key URLs

PURPOSE	URL
Your Admin Dashboard	<code>studelect.ng/{institution}/admin</code>
General Login	<code>studelect.ng/admin/login</code>
Voter Booth (share with students)	<code>studelect.ng/{institution}/{org}</code>
Results Page	<code>studelect.ng/{institution}/{org}</code> (scroll to results)
Ballot Verification	<code>studelect.ng/{institution}/elections/{id}/verify</code>

— Election Day Timeline (Recommended)

TIME	ACTION
Day Before	Complete voter roll upload / close registration, verify candidates with photos, test rules.
30 min before open	Log in, confirm all settings, check ELCOM help desk contacts, share booth link.
Election Opens	Set election to LIVE. Announce officially in all student channels.
Every 30 min	Check telemetry dashboard. Send reminder messages if turnout is low.
15 min before close	Send final countdown reminder to all students who have not yet voted.
Election Closes	Set election to ENDED. Export 1-Click JSON backup.
After closing	Export results CSV. Review audit log. Unseal results to Public.

TIME	ACTION
Within 1 hour	Make formal announcement of certified results with the public results link.

— Election Status Flow



IRREVERSIBLE ACTIONS

ENDED is permanent — once set, voting cannot reopen. Only set ENDED when you are certain all voting is complete. Also, ballots once cast cannot be undone.

— Emergency Contacts

ISSUE TYPE	CONTACT
Technical / Platform Issues	Your StudElect platform representative (WhatsApp)
License / Payment Holds	platform@studelect.ng
Privacy / Data Concerns	privacy@studelect.ng
Legal / Compliance	legal@studelect.ng